Guide to SETI

SET-UP

- Assemble the main board from the planetary board, solar system board, and the tech board.
- Shuffle the 5 alien species boards and place 2 at random face down in the slots at the edge of the planetary board.
- The 3 discs in the center of the board and the 4 sector boards surrounding them are laid out randomly. You can use the QR code to receive a random layout or randomize it yourself. The discs **MUST** line up to form 8 well-defined sectors with 1 nearby star in each sector. Place the sun in the middle.
- Shuffle the main deck of cards and deal 3 face up to form the card row.
- Keep the energy and credit tokens close by.
- Each nearby star gets enough data to fill its data slot. Keep the remaining data nearby.
- Place the gold scoring tiles beside the board with a random side face up.
- Place neutral milestones above the 20- and 30-point spaces on the scoring track, using markers of an unused color. For 1p/2p games, place 2 markers above each of the two spaces. For 3p games, place 1 marker above each space. In 4p games, these milestones are ignored.
- There are 12 different techs in the game. Each is depicted on the tech board – 4 in each of 3 colors. For each tech, shuffle the 4 matching tiles and place them on the matching space. The side depicting the technology should be face down. Place a 2 VP tile on top of each of the 12 stacks.
- Prepare 4 stacks of cards for the end of each round. Each stack contains 1 more card than players. After you pass in rounds 1-4, you will gain a card from that round's stack.
- Place 1 rotation token on the marked space of the tech board. Place the second token on the first pile of end of round cards. It is a reminder to rotate the solar system the first time a player passes in a round.

PLAYER SETUP

- Each player picks a color and takes the pieces in that color, keeping them near their board.
- Each player places their publicity marker on the 4 space of the publicity track.
- The last player to see a UFO is the starting player. Give them the starting player marker. The first player places their scoring marker on the 1 space of the score track, followed by player 2 in space 2, player 3 in space 3 and player 4 in space 4. Players play in clockwise order.
- Take the starting income card in your color and collect the starting resources – 4 publicity (microphone), 4 credits (C money), 3 energy (lightning), 5 random cards (card with ?). Finally, turn one of your cards into income (chart with rising arrow). Whenever you gain this symbol, tuck a card from your hand under your starting income card to permanently bolster your income. Finally, flip your start card – it shows your base income that you will receive from rounds 2 onward (along with any tucked cards).

GAME OVERVIEW

The game is played over 5 rounds. The player with the starting marker takes the first turn of the round with play going clockwise, skipping any passed players. At the end of round 5, final scores are calculated.

On your turn, you **ONLY** take 1 main action. In addition to your main action, you can do any free actions during your turn.

Once you have taken your main action and any free actions, your turn ends. You then need to resolve any milestones or discovered species. After that, it is the next player's turn. If a player passes, they are done for the round, but others may continue taking turns.

Once all players have passed, the round is finished and income is collected. The starting player marker moves to the next player who starts the next round.

CARD OVERVIEW

When a card is used, it is used for **ONLY ONE** of its benefits. If main action, **CANNOT** use for free action.

Free action (top left) – discard any time for the depicted benefit.

Main action (middle – cost on middle left) – pay the cost to play as a main action and perform its effect.

Mission/game end VP (bottom) – some cards have additional bonuses for conditions or game end VP.

Sector color (top right) – important for Scan action.

Income (bottom right) – this is the type of resource that this card becomes if it is tucked for income.

MAIN ACTIONS

The main actions are:

- Launch a probe (orange space shuttle)
- Orbit a planet (green satellite)
- Land on a planet or moon (yellow rover)
- Scan nearby stars (purple radar dish)
- Analyze data (blue computer)
- Play a card for its effect (card with arrow)
- Research a tech (tricolor splotch)
- Pass for the round (red X)

LAUNCH A PROBE – Pay 2 credits to launch a probe. Take 1 of your probe figures and place it on Earth. By default, each player can **ONLY HAVE ONE** probe "in space" – the rings of the solar system board. Figures on the planetary board are **NOT** "in space".

Having a probe on a planet gives you the option to turn it into an orbiter or a lander.

You move probes with the Movement free action. Movement is generated by paying energy or using cards with the Movement free action icon.

ORBIT A PLANET – Pay 1 credit and 1 energy to turn one of your probes into an orbiter. This is a main action that will be performed if your probe is on a planet space other than Earth.

Turning a probe into an orbiter will usually give you an income increase.

To orbit a planet, remove your figure from the solar system board and place it in orbit of that planet on the planetary board. Gain the bonuses shown above the planet. The first player to enter orbit around a planet also scores 3 VP. To remind later players not to score these points, cover the space with your figure. There is **NO** limit to the number of orbiters a planet can have.

LAND ON A PLANET OR MOON – Pay 3 energy to turn one of your probes into a lander. This main action can **ONLY** be performed if your probe is on a space with a planet other than Earth. If there is any player's orbiter at that planet already, this only costs 2 energy instead.

Landing on planets is the primary way to earn yellow traces .

To land on a planet, remove your figure from the solar system board and place it on that planet on the planetary board.

Gain the bonuses in the middle of the planet. This **ALWAYS** include a and some number of VP. The first player to land on a planet also receives some data. To remind everyone that later landers will not receive this data, cover the space with your figure. Mars is unique as it has **TWO** of these spaces instead of just one. If you are the first to land on Mars, you choose which space to cover. There is **NO** limit to the number of landers you can have on a planet.

Some planets have one or more moons. You **CANNOT** land on these unless some effect or tech allows you to do so. When you land on a moon, gain the depicted rewards. Each moon has space for **ONLY ONE** lander.

Marking Life Traces *– whenever you earn one of these icons* *, you have found extraterrestrial life! Below each alien board are 3 discovery spaces matching the 3 types of traces. Place your marker on a matching space if one is still unmarked. If both are full and no alien has been discovered, place your marker in an overflow space below.*

You gain 1 publicity and 5 VP as shown for claiming the space with your marker. It may also give you other benefits when this alien is discovered later.

- this is the icon for universal trace – a wildcard that can stand for ***ANY*** *of the life traces.*

SCAN NEARBY STARS – Pay 1 credit and 2 energy to scan nearby stars. This main action allows you to listen for signals and receive data without needing a probe. Scanning sectors is the primary way to earn red traces .

To scan, perform the steps illustrated on your player board in the order of your choice. Mark 1 signal in Earth's sector. Discard a card from the card row and mark 1 signal in a matching sector

If you have any telescope techs, you may activate those in any order, paying any additional costs.

You **ALWAYS** mark at least 2 signals, but could mark up to 4 with the right techs!

Marking Signals – *during play, you may have several opportunities to mark a signal in a sector. To do this, take the leftmost data token from that sector's data slot. Put the data in your data pool on your player board and replace it with a marker in your color. If you place it in a sector's second data slot,* ***IMMEDIATELY*** *score 2 VP.*

You may have the opportunity to place more markers than a sector can hold. This is ok. You don't get data for these extra markers, but they can help you win a sector once it's completed. Data is replaced by markers in order from left to right.

Completing a Sector – *if you replace the last data token in a sector, the sector is completed. When you finish your main action, resolve all completed sectors in any order you choose.*

The player with the most markers in the data slot wins the sector. That player places a marker on the space beside the nearby star and gets the reward shown.

Any excess signals count toward winning. If there is a tie, the tiebreaker is whose marker was placed ***LATER****.*

Each player that contributed at least one marker gets 1 publicity, including the winner.

Resetting the Sector – *after determining the winner, determine who got second, using the same tiebreaker. The second place player (if there is one) leaves their marker on the first space of the sector.*

Return ALL other markers from the data slot to the respective players and refill empty spaces with data tokens, just like at setup.

The sector can be won again later with winners leaving their markers in the overflow slot, gaining the lesser reward.

ANALYZE DATA – Pay 1 energy to analyze the data you've collected. This is a main action that can **ONLY** be performed if the top row of your computer is filled with data. If you have computer techs, you also have spaces in the bottom row. These can be filled or empty. Analyzing data is the primary way to earn blue traces .

To analyze your data, discard every data token in your computer, but **NOT** the data in your data pool (blue rectangle). Then mark a for one of the two aliens. Your computer will now be empty and can be filled with data once again.

PLAY A CARD – As your main action, you can play a card for its effect (white part of card). The cost is printed on the left middle. If the card's effect includes other actions, you perform the action **WITHOUT** paying its cost. After resolving its effect, place the card face up in a discard pile near the main deck, unless it is a mission or game end scoring card – keep in front of you.

Conditional Missions: Cards in this format state a condition and a reward you receive when the condition is met. At **ANY** time during your turn, if the condition is a met, you can complete the mission as a free action.

If you already meet the condition when you play the card, you can choose to complete it **IMMEDIATELY**. You are also not required to complete a mission as soon as you meet its condition. Keep it face down.

Triggerable Missions: Missions in this format can be triggered by things you do. When you trigger the mission, you may choose to cover the circle with one of your markers to gain the bonus. Only things you do **AFTER** playing the mission can trigger it, **NOTHING** you did **BEFORE** playing it. Each circle can only be covered **ONCE**.

It is possible to trigger these missions even outside of your turn.

If one effect would trigger multiple rewards on the same or different cards, you may choose to cover any of those spaces, but only a single space at a time.

Once all spaces have been covered, the mission is automatically completed – keep it face down.

End of Game Scoring Cards: Cards with gold boxes offer you VP at the end of the game. After resolving its effects, keep it in front of you for the rest of the game.

RESEARCH A TECH – Pay 6 publicity to research a new technology as your main action. When you research a tech, you start by rotating the solar system. Then you

choose one of the techs you don't have yet (**CANNOT** have duplicates) and take the top tech tile from the chosen stack.

If you are the first person to take a tech from that stack, discard the 2 VP tile and score 2 VP **IMMEDIATELY**.

Each tech tile has a bonus printed on it. Gain this bonus **IMMEDIATELY** and then flip the tile over and place it on your board.

Probe (orange) and telescope (red) techs have specific slots on your board. A computer tech (blue) can be placed in **ANY** computer slot. If there is already a data token there, just slip the tech tile under it. This is not considered placing data, so you won't score for the 2 VP space your data token is now covering.

A card with the tech icons lets you research a specific tech just like a regular research action. The card reminds you to rotate the system too. You do **NOT** pay publicity to get a tech from a card effect. If a card tries to get a tech you already have or when you already have all 4 of that type, ignore that part. You still rotate the solar system.

Rotating the Solar System – *You **ALWAYS** rotate the solar system when you research a tech, whether by main action or a card effect. Also, in **EACH** round, the first player to pass rotates the solar system. When you rotate over the yellow icon, move the top disc, the orange icon moves the middle disc, and the blue icon moves the bottom disc.*

*Probe figures will rotate with discs and may even be bumped by discs. Just move it to the next space. This movement is always free and if it gives publicity, you gain it **IMMEDIATELY**.*

PASS – Passing is a main action, which means you CAN still do free actions when you pass. After doing any free actions, resolve these steps in order:

1 – Discard down to 4 cards if you have more than 4.

2 – Check whether you need to rotate the solar system. If you are the first to pass, rotate the solar system. In round 5, you still rotate, but discard the token.

3 – Choose ONE card from this round's end of round cards and return the rest to their space. Once everyone has passed, the round ends as soon as the last player chooses one of the 2 remaining cards and discards the leftover one.

FREE ACTIONS

Movement – This allows you to move your probes around the solar system. For each movement point, you can move your probe into an adjacent (non-diagonal) space. Asteroids require an additional movement point to leave (noted on player board).

If you move into a space with a publicity icon, you gain it – you do **NOT** need to stop there to gain it.

Placing Data – At any time during your turn, you may take a data token from your data pool and place it in your computer as a free action. Data is placed from left to right. When you place it on a space with an effect, resolve that effect **IMMEDIATELY**. Data can only be placed during your turn.

For tech tiles with two spaces, the bottom space is optional, but **CANNOT** be filled unless the space above is filled first.

Your data pool can **NEVER** hold more than 6 data at a time. If you ever gain data when your data pool is full, you **MUST** discard the excess.

Completing a Mission – Missions can be completed during your turn as a free action. Gain the reward.

Free Action Corner – Discard a card from hand to use its free action corner (top left corner).

Buy a Card – Spend 3 publicity to gain a card from either the card row or from the top of the deck. Any time you take a card from the card row, replace it **IMMEDIATELY**. If the deck is ever empty, reshuffle the discard pile.

Exchange Resources – Exchange 2 credits / 2 energy / 2 cards for any 1 credit / 1 energy / 1 card. Cards are taken from the card row or the top of the deck.

MILESTONES – Some events are triggered when a player's score counter reaches or passes a certain score on the track. These events are resolved between

turns, after the current player has finished playing free actions.

Gold Milestones – At the end of a turn where you reach or pass 25, 50, or 70 VP, you choose one of the gold scoring tiles and mark it. You **CANNOT** mark the same tile twice.

Each one has multiple spaces worth a varying amount of VP. The first player to choose that tile places their marker on the highest value. The next player to choose places on the second highest value, and so on. There is room for everyone to choose the same tile.

Neutral Milestones – In games with fewer than 4p, you placed nonplayer markers at the 20 and 30 point milestones during setup. At the end of a turn in which you reach or pass these milestones, a nonplayer research group discovers something important about one of the two species. If any of the 3 spaces under each alien is empty, move a nonplayer marker from the milestone to the leftmost empty space. It is possible that this will lead to the discovery of an alien species.

If all 6 spaces are already full when hitting this milestone, the both species have been discovered and these neutral milestones have no effect. In a 4p game, these milestones are completely ignored.

Multiple Milestones – Milestones are resolved between turns. If multiple players have reached milestones, they resolve them in order, starting with the player whose turn has just ended and proceeding clockwise. The neutral milestone belongs to nonplayers and is **ALWAYS** resolved last.

BETWEEN ROUNDS

Three things need to be done between rounds:

1 – **EVERYONE** gets income. The resources shown on your starting income card plus the resources on all cards you have tucked.

2 – Pass the starting player marker one player to the left.

3 – Move the rotation reminder token onto the stack of cards for the next round.

DISCOVERING ALIEN SPECIES

Once all three discovery spaces are filled by player/nonplayer markers, that alien species is discovered.

There are overflow spaces for extra alien traces. Sometimes, you need to mark a trace, but all the spaces for that color are taken. You can always place in the alien overflow space and score 3 VP. If a card refers to a trace marked for an alien species, all markers in the discovery and overflow spaces count as well.

If a species is discovered during your turn, resolve the discovery **AFTER** you finish your turn. If there are any milestones, resolve them **BEFORE** the discovery.

1 – Flip the species board over to reveal which species has been discovered.

2 – Read the rule sheet for that species.

3 – Follow the setup rules for the revealed alien species. The players that marked the 3 discovery spaces will be rewarded at this time.

Each alien species comes with a special deck of cards. These are slightly stronger than regular cards and may be gained only from the alien species. In your hand, follow the rules of regular cards **EXCEPT** for the Exertian species cards, which do **NOT** count toward your hand limit.

The additional spaces on each alien species board function just like the 3 discovery spaces. When you gain a life trace, mark **ANY** empty space of the matching color to gain the reward. Nonplayer markers only play on the 6 discovery spaces below the alien boards.

GAME END

The game ends after 5 rounds. Once the last player passes, it is time for final scoring:

- End of game scoring cards (gold boxes)
- Gold scoring tiles
- Some aliens may add an additional scoring step

The player with the most VP wins. There is no tiebreaker.